



Day	Beekeeper activity	Bee activity	Queen development
-	The previous fall and earlier in the spring, boost the population of a strong colony to use as a cell finisher, through generous feeding. Keep this hive from swarming through cutting out swarm cells.		
1	You may confine the queen to one frame or area of a frame in advance, to easily find 24-hour old larvae.	Queen lays eggs.	Egg
2			
3	Prepare cell builder.	Just before the egg hatches, nurse bees will begin to provision the cell with royal jelly.	Egg hatches
4	Graft 24-hour old larvae and place graft frame into cell builder. Prepare cell finisher.	In the cell builder, eager nurse bees are consuming food, creating royal jelly, and feeding royal jelly to the young larvae. They also start drawing out the queen cells with wax.	Larva
5	Remove grafting frame from cell starter and place it in cell finisher.	After 24 hours in the cell starter, the nurse bees are still feeding the developing queens with royal jelly, but the level wanes with the large number of queen cells in the starter colony. In the cell finisher, the new nurses will continue caring for the developing queens.	
6	Do not touch grafting frame: the developing queens are very fragile in this state!	Nurse bees continue to feed developing queens. The composition of the food changes slightly as the larvae age. Wax is continuously added to the queen cells.	
7		Nurse bees make a final provisioning of royal jelly to the queen cell and then seal it.	
8			
9			
10			
11			Pupa
12	Make up mating nucs (the day before you remove the queen cells)		
13			
14	Remove queen cells from cell builders (to transfer to mating nucs or ship to customers) or place cages over each cell. Handle with care.		
15			
16			Queen emerges
17			Virgin queen
18			
19			
20			Short orientation flights
21			
22			



23		Between one and five mating flight(s) can take place between day 23 and 32, depending on the weather conditions.	Mating flights begin
24			
25			
26			
27			
28		Two to five days after mating, the queen begins laying eggs. This usually happens between day 25 and 37. The queen does not leave the hive again, unless she is in a swarm.	Egg laying begins
29			
30			
31			
32			